actors who had met the challenge and succeeded in getting the AFL to oust the mobsters.

Now there was another problem. The rump CSU group was run by a man named Herb Sorrell, head of the studio painters' union, who set out with a plan to gain jurisdictional control over a group of workers within an IATSE branch called the Set Erectors. There were only about 350 set erectors in the whole industry but the CSU called a strike demanding that the studios recognize it as their exclusive bargaining agent.

The IATSE told its members to cross the CSU picket lines and war broke out. Naturally, actors and actresses came to the officers of the Guild, asking us what they should do.

At a meeting of Guild directors, I proposed that we try to set up a meeting between the management of the studios, the CSU leaders, and the leaders of IATSE to determine what was going on. The studio executives were a little reluctant at first, but we assured them that the Guild, as a neutral party, would be there to referee and make sure there weren't any shenanigans.

When we held the meeting, it was obvious that the CSU strike was a phony. It wasn't meant to improve the wages and working conditions of its members, but to grab something from another union that was rightfully theirs.

The actors were in a key position: If we refused to cross the CSU picket lines, the industry would be shut down. If we crossed the lines, it could stay open and make movies.

Those of us who had attended the meeting reported to the Guild's Board of Directors that we thought it was not a legitimate strike but a jurisdictional dispute between two unions and recommended that the actors cross the picket lines.

The directors called a meeting of the full membership of the Guild at the Hollywood boxing stadium the following